CalWORKs Program Guide: CalWORKs Outcomes and Accountability Review (

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

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Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 10-170: QUALITY IMPROVEMENT
TITLE: CALWORKS OUTCOMES AND ACCOUNTABILITY REVIEW (CAL-OAR)

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE

The CalWORKs Outcomes and Accountability Review (Cal-OAR) is California's statewide continuous quality improvement and performance assessment system established under Welfare and Institutions Code Section 11523. Cal-OAR shifts the CalWORKs program evaluation from narrow process compliance to substantive family self-sufficiency, educational attainment, and long-term child and family well-being.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & PERFORMANCE MEASURES

? Core Evaluation Components: Cal-OAR operates on a three-year continuous quality improvement cycle consisting of:
(1) Performance Measures: Standardized data metrics tracking employment entries, earnings progression, credential attainment, supportive service utilization, and sanction cure rates;
(2) County Self-Assessment (CSA): A comprehensive multi-year evaluation of local county operational strengths, service gaps, and customer voice;
(3) System Improvement Plan (SIP): An actionable strategic roadmap setting quantitative targets and procedural enhancements over a three-year period.
? Family-Centered Focus: Cal-OAR metrics evaluate holistic family stability, housing retention, and child care access rather than solely mechanical hourly participation.
? Public Reporting: San Diego County submits all Cal-OAR performance data and SIP updates directly to the California Department of Social Services (CDSS) for statewide publication.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST

? Data Integrity: Caseworkers must accurately log all WTW component activities, supportive services payments, and employment entries in CalSAWS to ensure reliable state data extraction.
? Continuous Engagement: Implement peer review and quality improvement feedback to

reduce participant dropouts and enhance employment outcomes.